

World : Population & Urbanization

1. During 10000 BC, the population of the world was :

- (a) 2 million
- (b) 3 million
- (c) 4 million
- (d) 5 million
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (*)

Estimates of the population of the world at the time agriculture emerged around 10,000 BC have ranged between 1 million and 10 million. Hence, option (e) is the correct answer.

2. Which one of the following countries of the world has the largest Indian population as on December 2018?

- (a) United Arab Emirates
- (b) Malaysia
- (c) United Kingdom
- (d) United States of America
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

As per the data available on the website of Indian Ministry of Foreign Affairs, United Arab Emirates is the country which has the largest Indian population as on December 2018, while Saudi Arabia has the second largest Indian population. As per the current data of Ministry of External Affairs, United states of America has largest population of Overseas Indians and then United Arab Emirate.

E. MISCELLANEOUS

1. Which state has made roof top rainwater harvesting structure compulsory to all houses across the state?

- (a) Kerala
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Karnataka
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (b)

Tamil Nadu is the first and the only state in India which has made roof top rainwater harvesting structure compulsory to all the houses across the state. To stop groundwater depletion, the project began in 2001 and has since been initiated in all of Tamil Nadu's rural areas. Rainwater harvesting is promoted through posters in Tamil Nadu, including rural areas.

2. Which Indian state is first to follow the recommendations and exercises mentioned under Sendai framework agreement?

- (a) Bihar
- (b) Madhya Pradesh
- (c) Chhattisgarh
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (a)

Bihar is probably the first state to follow the recommendations and exercises mentioned under Sendai Framework agreement. The Sendai Framework for Disaster Risk Reduction is an international document that was adopted by the United Nations member states on 18 March 2015 at the World Conference on Disaster Risk Reduction held in Sendai, Japan and endorsed by the UN General Assembly in June 2015.

3. In which decades was the rationing system introduced in India?

- (a) 1960s
- (b) 1950s
- (c) 1940s
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (c)

Rationing is a system of allocating limited resources, such as food, clothing, and fuel, to a population on a regular basis. It is usually implemented during times of war or other emergencies when the supply of essential goods is limited. The Rationing System was introduced in India during the 1940s, a decade marked by the Second World War. India was then under British rule, and the war had a severe impact on the country's economy and resources. It was also the period of Bengal famine. Food shortages were a common problem, and the government had to take decisive steps to ensure that the population had access to essential goods.

4. IREDA was developed by the Government of India for

- (a) To promote only conventional energy sources
- (b) To control pollution
- (c) To develop nuclear energy in India
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

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Ans. (e)

Indian Renewable Energy Development Agency Limited (IREDA) was established on 11th March, 1987 as a Public limited Government Company under the Companies Act, 1956 and it promotes, develops and extends financial assistance for Renewable Energy and Energy Efficiency/ Conservation Projects.

5. Who wrote the book, Indian Economic Crisis?

- (a) K. N. Raj
- (b) A. K. Sen
- (c) C. T. Kurien
- (d) L. C. Jain
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (c)

Indian Economic Crisis: A Diagnostic Study was written by C. T. Kurien. The book is the study of the crisis in the economy and of economic policy of India - covers economic theory, savings, investment, economic planning for economic growth, inflation, and the possibility of adopting a socialist system. C. T. Kurien is a professor of economics, now retired and reside in Bangalore, wrote many books on economics. He was chairman of the Madras Institute of Development Studies from 1997 to 2003, when he retired from academic work.

6. Due to oil crisis, most of the developed countries faced the problem of

- (a) inflation
- (b) deflation
- (c) stagflation
- (d) demand and supply
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (a)

Crude oil is a major economic input, so a rise in oil prices contributes to inflation, which measures the overall rate of price increases across the economy. Higher oil prices contribute to inflation directly and by increasing the cost of inputs. There was a strong correlation between inflation and oil prices during the 1970s. Oil's potential to stoke inflation has declined as the U.S. economy has become less dependent on it now.

7. Which of the following statements about non-plan expenditures of the Central Government is correct?

- (a) The expenditure is on interest payments.
- (b) The expenditure is on science and technology.
- (c) The expenditure is on agriculture.

- (d) None of the above

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (a)

Interest payments come under non-plan expenditure while expenditure on science and technology and agriculture are plan expenditure.

8. "Inflation is unjust but deflation is inexpedient." Who said this?

- (a) J. R. Hicks
- (b) Mrs. Joan Robinson
- (c) J. M. Keynes
- (d) A. C. Pigou
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Project Manager Prelims 2021

Ans. (c)

The quote "Inflation is unjust but deflation is inexpedient" is often attributed to John Maynard Keynes, an influential British economist. He is best known for his work on macro economic theories and policies.

9. The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code became operational in

- (a) 2016
- (b) 2017
- (c) 2018
- (d) 2019
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Project Manager Prelims 2021

Ans. (a)

The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code of 2016 (IBC), implemented on May 28, 2016, amidst a rising tide of non-performing loans, aims to create a comprehensive system for expeditious insolvency resolution of corporate entities, partnership firms, and individuals, in a time-bound manner.

10. In which budget did the Finance Minister announce the Liberalized Exchange Rate Management System?

- (a) Union Budget, 1993-1994
- (b) Union Budget, 1991-1992
- (c) Union Budget, 1992-1993
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (c)

In Union Budget, 1992-93, the Finance Minister announced the Liberalized Exchange Rate Management System. The Liberalized Exchange Rate Management System refers to a flexible and market-driven approach to managing a country's exchange rate.

11. India's first floating financial literacy camp was organized recently by India Post Payments Bank in which of the following locations?

- (a) Kerala (b) Srinagar
- (c) Andaman Islands (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

India's first floating financial literacy camp was organised by India Post Payments Bank in Dal Lake of Srinagar, J&K in November 2022 under Niveshak Didi. Camp focus was to raise financial awareness on 'For the women, by the women' approach.

12. National Waterway-1 connects-

- (a) Kottapuram to Kollam (b) Sadiya to Dhubri
- (c) Haldia to Allahabad (d) Haldia to Kolkata
- (e) None of the above / more than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

The part of Bhagirathi- Hooghly Ganga river system from 'Allahabad to Haldia' has been declared as National Waterway No-1. It was established in the year 1986. Its total length is 1620 km. It is the longest inland waterway of the country. At present a total of 13 National Waterways are currently operational in India. A total of 111 waterways have been declared as National Waterways by the National Waterways Act, 2016.

13. According to Forbes magazine, the richest person in the world in 2007 is-

- (a) Carlos Slim Helu (b) Bill Gates
- (c) Lakshmi Mittal (d) Warren Buffett

48th to 52nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2008

Ans. (d)

Warren Buffett was the world's richest man in 2007, according to Forbes magazine during the Question Hour. Elon Musk (owner of Space X and Tesla) has topped the Forbes World's billionaire list in the year 2023 (July) with \$240.7 billion. Still in 2024 Elon Musk is the richest person in the world.

14. In which year the Railway Budget was merged with the General Budget in India?

- (a) 2015 (b) 2016
- (c) 2017 (d) 2018
- (e) None of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

In the year 2017, the Railway Budget was merged with the General Budget. In the year 2017, in the general budget itself, the railway budget was presented by the then Finance Minister Arun Jaitley.

15. Diesel prices were increased recently-

- (a) To increase the income of the government
- (b) Arbitrary decision of the government
- (c) To fix prices accordingly at the level of international prices, which is a follow-up to the steps taken by the previous government.
- (d) none of these

43rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1999

In the year 1999, the government spent Rs. 1 per liter cess was imposed on diesel for road development. Due to which diesel prices were increased by Rs.1. Again, to adjust the domestic diesel prices to the international price, the government increased the diesel price by 32 to 34 paise per litre. Since 2014, the diesel price completely determined by international market prices.

16. Which statement is not true about the poverty estimates based on the 68th round of NSSO?

- (a) The poverty line defined at ₹27.20 per capita per day for rural areas.
- (b) The poverty line defined at ₹33.33 per capita per day for urban areas.
- (c) The 21.9 per cent population of India was living below the poverty line.
- (d) The 33.35 per cent population of India was living below the poverty line.
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

67th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2021

Ans. (d)

According to the report submitted by Tendulkar committee in the year 2012 (based on NSSO Survey) statements (a), (b) and (c) are correct while statement (d) is incorrect. Hence option (d) is the correct answer.

Environment and Ecology

1. Environment is a composite state of :

- (a) Biotic factors
- (b) Physiographic factors
- (c) Abiotic factors
- (d) All of the above.

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (d)

The environment may be divided into biotic and abiotic environments. The biotic environment is made up of biotic factors, i.e. all living things in the environment. The abiotic or physical environment is made up of all the physical factors that affect organisms, e.g. temperature, light intensity, the amount of available water etc.

2. What is the thin layer of gases around the earth called?

- (a) Biosphere
- (b) Water particle
- (c) Atmosphere
- (d) Hydrosphere

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

The thin layer of gases surrounding the earth is called the atmosphere. The majority of the Earth's atmosphere consists of a high amount of Nitrogen, along with smaller amounts of Oxygen and Carbon dioxide.

3. The atmosphere is mainly heated by the

- (a) long-wave terrestrial radiation
- (b) short-wave solar radiation
- (c) reflected solar radiation
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (a)

The insolation received by the earth is in shortwave forms and heats its surface. The earth after being heated itself becomes a radiating body and it radiates energy to the atmosphere in long-wave form. This energy heat the atmosphere from below. This process is know as terrestrial radiation. The long wave radiation is absorbed by the atmospheric gases particularly by carbon dioxide and the other greenhouse gases. Thus, the atmosphere is indirectly heated by Earth's radiation.

4. Air is a/an:

- (a) Compound
- (b) Element
- (c) Mixture
- (d) Electrolyte

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (c)

Air is a mixture of gases. By volume, about 78% of this mixture is nitrogen and about 21% is oxygen. Carbon dioxide, argon, methane, ozone and water vapour are also present in very small quantities.

5. The highest percentage of gas in the air is :

- (a) Hydrogen
- (b) Carbon dioxide
- (c) Oxygen
- (d) Nitrogen

41st B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1996

Ans. (d)

The air around us is a mixture of gases, mainly Nitrogen and Oxygen, but containing much smaller amounts of Water vapour, Argon, and Carbon Dioxide and very small amounts of other gases.

Gas	Percentage
Nitrogen (N)	78.08%
Oxygen (O)	20.947%
Argon (Ar)	0.93%
Carbon dioxide (CO ₂)	0.0407%
Neon (Ne)	0.0018%
Helium (He)	0.0005%
Krypton	0.0001%
Hydrogen (H)	0.000053%
Xenon	0.000009%

6. Where was the 4th session of the UN Environment Assembly (UNEA-4) held recently?

- (a) Paris-France
- (b) Ulaanbaatar-Mongolia
- (c) Beijing - China
- (d) Nairobi-Kenya
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

The fourth session of the United Nations Environment Assembly (UNEA-4) took place from 11-15 March 2019 in Nairobi, Kenya. The theme of UNEA-4 was "Innovative solutions for Environmental Challenges and Sustainable Consumption and Production". It is noteworthy that the fifth session of UNEA took place (Virtually) in Nairobi in February 2021, under the theme, " Strengthening Actions for Nature to Achieve the Sustainable Development Goals". A resumed in-person session of UNEA-5 is scheduled to take place from 28th February-2 March, 2022. The overall theme for UNEA-5 was "Strengthening Actions for Nature to Achieve the Sustainable Development Goals."

7. The tallest known living tree:

- (a) Eucalyptus (b) Sequoia
(c) Deodar (d) Parnang

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (b)

The tallest known tree is Redwood (Sequoia Sempervirens). It is found in California (U.S.A.). This species includes the tallest living trees on Earth, reaching up to 367 feet (111.862 m) in height.

8. The Ramsar Convention is associated with the conservation of

- (a) drylands (b) wetlands
(c) forests (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (b)

The Convention on Wetlands of International Importance, more commonly known as the Ramsar Convention, is an international agreement promoting the conservation and wise use of wetlands. The definition of the word 'wetland', under the convention, is any land area that is saturated or flooded with water, either seasonally or permanently. Inland wetlands include acqifers, lakes, rivers, streams, marshes, peatlands, ponds, flood plains and swamps. Coastal wetlands include all coastlines, mangroves saltmarshes, estuaries, lagoons, seagrass meadows and coral reefs.

9. Among the following pairs of Ramsar Site and State, which one of the following is not correctly matched?

- (a) Sur Sarovar-Uttar Pradesh (b) Thol-Gujarat
(c) Ashtamudi-Kerala (d) Lonar-Rajasthan
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Assistant Audit Officer 2022

Ans. (d)

Correctly matched Ramsar sites and States -

Ramsar Sites	States
Sur-Sarovar	Uttar Pradesh
Thol	Gujarat
Ashtamudi	Kerala
Lonar	Maharashtra

As of 31 January 2024, India has a total of 80 Ramsar sites. India became a party to the Convention in 1982.

10. Bihar's first Ramsar Site is located in:

- (a) Begusarai (b) Banka
(c) Bhagalpur (d) Bhojpur
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2020

Ans. (a)

Bihar's first Ramsar Site Kabartal Wetland is located in Begusarai District of the State. Kabartal Wetlands covers an area of 26.20 square kilometers and declared as Ramsar Sites on 21st July, 2020.

11. Which gas contributes to global warming through its greenhouse effect?

- (a) Carbon dioxide (b) Nitrous oxide
(c) Methane (d) More than one of the above
(e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (d)

Several green house gases contribute to global warming through their greenhouse effect. The major greenhouse gases are—

1. Carbon dioxide (CO₂)
2. Methane (CH₄)
3. Nitrous Oxide (N₂O)
4. Fluorinated Gases (HFCs, PFCs & SF₆)

These green house gases trap heat in the Earth's atmosphere, preventing it from escaping into space. As a result, they contribute to the greenhouse effect, which leads to an increase in global temperatures and contributes to climate change.

12. Which of the following is a greenhouse gas?

- (a) Carbon dioxide (b) Ozone
(c) CFC (d) Methane
(e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (e)

See the explanation of the above question.

13. The main component of greenhouse gases is:

- (a) Carbon dioxide (b) Methane
(c) Nitrous oxide (d) Ozone
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (e)

The six major gases identified as Green House Gases by Intergovernmental Panel on climate change include CH₄, CFC, and N₂O. While sulphur dioxide (SO₂) is not a greenhouse gas, it is responsible for acid rain. The Bihar Public Service Commission has marked the correct answer as option (e) whereas they have considered option (c) as correct in the previous answer sheet. Probably this would have been done on the basis of direct and indirectly involved gases in greenhouse effect. The gases directly responsible for greenhouse effect are – Carbon dioxide (CO₂), Methane (CH₄), Nitrous Oxide (N₂O), CFC, SF₆, NF₃, etc. While the gases indirectly responsible for green house effect include - Nitrogen oxide (NO_x), Carbon monoxide (CO), Non-methane volatile organic compounds (NMVOC) and sulphur dioxide (SO₂).

14. Which of the following gas is responsible for the depletion of Ozone Layer?

- (a) Carbon dioxide (b) Carbon monooxide
(c) Nitrous oxide (d) Chlorofluorocarbon

42nd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1997

Ans. (d)

Ozone depletion occurs when chlorofluorocarbons (CFCs) are released into the atmosphere. These gases, through several chemical reactions, cause the ozone molecules to break down, reducing ozone's ultraviolet radiation absorbing capacity.

15. What is the theme of the 2018 International Day of Forests?

- (a) Forests and Water
(b) Forests and Energy
(c) Forests and Sustainable cities
(d) Forests and Life
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (c)

The United Nations General Assembly proclaimed 21st March the International Day of Forests (IDF) in 2012. IDF celebrates and raises awareness of the importance of all types of forests. The theme of IDF 2018 was 'Forests and Sustainable Cities', whereas the theme of 2023 is "Forests and Health".

16. What is the percentage of forest area in the total geographical area of India?

- (a) 24.5 % (b) 21 %
(c) 20 % (d) 22 %

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (*)

According to India State of Forest Report 2017 released in February, 2018. India is ranked 10th in the world, with 24.4% of land area under forest and tree cover. Land area under forest cover was 21.54% and tree cover was 2.85%. According to the recent data of ISFR, 2021, the total Forest cover has been observed as 7,13,789 Sq. km area of the country which is 21.71% of the geographical area of the country.

17. According to India State of Forest Report released in February 2018, how much area of India is covered by forests?

- (a) 23.00% (b) 23.40%
(c) 24.00% (d) 24.40%
(e) None of the above/More than one option

64th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (e)

According to the India State of Forest Report-2017, 21.54 percent of the geographical area is under forest cover and 2.85 percent under tree cover (total 24.40 percent). So, the most possible answer is option (b). Recent data (ISFR, 2021) for the above question is 21.71 percent.

18. The largest percentage of forest area is in :

- (a) Arunachal Pradesh (b) Himachal Pradesh
(c) Mizoram (d) Nagaland

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

According to India State of Forest Report (ISFR) 2021 & 2019, States are given in option has an area under forest-

State	2021	2019
Mizoram	84.53%	85.41%
Arunachal Pradesh	79.33%	79.63%
Nagaland	73.90%	75.31%
Tripura	73.64%	73.68%

19. Which one of the following States has the highest percentage of area under forests?

- (a) Himachal Pradesh (b) Assam
(c) Andhra Pradesh (d) Arunachal Pradesh
(e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

According to India State Forest Report (ISFR) 2021, states are given in option has the highest percentage of area under forests—Arunachal Pradesh (79.33%), Assam (36.09%), Andhra Pradesh (18.28%) and Himachal Pradesh (27.73%). So Arunachal Pradesh has highest percentage of area under forests.

20. In National Park protection is given to—

- (a) Only Fauna
- (b) The whole ecosystem
- (c) Only Flora
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}–2024

Ans. (b)

An area, notified by the State/Central government by reason of its ecological, faunal, floral, geomorphologic, or zoological association or importance, needed for the purpose of protecting & propagating or developing wildlife therein or its environment. A National Park is the highest level of protection that can be given to an area under the Wildlife (Protection), Act, 1972.

There are 106 existing national parks in India covering an area of 44,402.95 km², which is 1.35% of the geographical area of the country (National Wildlife Database Centre, Nov. 2023).

21. The Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE) has signed MoU with TIFAC for supporting forest-based communities. Where is the headquarters of ICFRE located?

- (a) Hyderabad
- (b) Bengaluru
- (c) Allahabad
- (d) Dehradun
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

Indian Council of Forestry Research and Education (ICFRE) is an apex body in the National forestry research system that promotes and undertakes need based forestry research extension. Its headquarters is located at Dehradun, Uttarakhand.

22. Among the following districts, which one has larger area under dense deciduous forest cover?

- (a) Paschim Champaran
- (b) Gaya
- (c) Kaimur
- (d) Nawada
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

Among the given options Paschim Champaran has larger area under dense deciduous forest cover.

23. Which of the following areas in India does not grow tropical wet evergreen forests?

- (a) Eastern Ghats
- (b) Western Ghats
- (c) Andaman Islands
- (d) Northeastern Region
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2018

Ans. (a)

Tropical Evergreen forests are restricted to heavy rainfall area of the western Ghats and the island group's of Lakshadweep, Andaman and Nicobar, upper parts of Assam and Tamil Nadu coast. They are at their best in area having more than 200 cm of rainfall with a short dry season.

24. In which forest do the majority of species of birds inhabit the mountainous areas?

- (a) Pine forest
- (b) Bush forest
- (c) Oak forest
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}–2024

Ans. (a)

Mountainous pine forests are critical habitats for a wide range of bird species. The unique ecological characteristics of these forests provide essential nesting sites, food resources, and protection, making them vital for avian biodiversity.

25. India's first Dolphin Observatory is being built in:

- (a) Delhi
- (b) Mumbai
- (c) Bihar
- (d) Odisha
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2020

Ans. (c)

India's first Dolphin Observatory 'Vikramshila Gangetic Dolphin Sanctuary' is located in Bhagalpur District of Bihar.

26. The State of India with maximum number of wildlife sanctuaries is :

- (a) Karnataka
- (b) Tamil Nadu
- (c) Maharashtra
- (d) Madhya Pradesh
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre.) 2020

Ans. (e)

Andaman and Nicobar Island (97) has the maximum number of wildlife sanctuaries (Source - ENVIS centre on wildlife and protected Areas).

27. Which of the following is the only UNESCO World Heritage Site present in Bihar State of India?

- (a) Mahabodhi Vihar
- (b) Buddhist Monastery in Nalanda
- (c) Ancient site of Vikramashila Monastery
- (d) Tomb of Sher Shah Suri
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (e)

Mahabodhi Temple Complex at Bodh Gaya (2002) and Archaeological Site of Nalanda Mahavihar at Nalanada, (2016) are included in the list of UNESCO World Heritage Site in Bihar state of India. Hence option (e) is correct answer.

28. The world's largest population of tigers is in India. It is estimated :

- (a) 6000
- (b) 16000
- (c) 60000
- (d) 10600

40th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (*)

The total estimated population of tigers in the world is 3000-4500. India is home to 3167 (According to status of Tigers 2022) tigers which is highest as compared to other countries in the world. Hence, none of the options is correct.

29. Which one of the following is the well- publicised wildlife campaign in the world launched in 1973?

- (a) Sunderbans Project
- (b) Project Tiger
- (c) Lion Project
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

Project Tiger is a Tiger Conservation Programme Launched in April 1973 by the Government of India during Prime Minister Indira Gandhi's tenure. The project aims at ensuring a viable population of tigers in their natural habitats. Protecting them from extinction, and preserving area of biological importance as a natural heritage forever represented as close as possible the diversity of ecosystems across the distribution of tigers in the country.

30. Which one of the following is *not* included under *in situ* conservation?

- (a) Botanical Garden
- (b) National Park
- (c) Wildlife Sanctuary
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (a)

In situ conservation invites the maintenance of genetic variation at the location where it is encountered or in setu conservation, the organisms or ecosystem is conserved in their surroundings. It includes biosphere reserves, national parks, wildlife sanctuaries etc.

31. Which one of the following National Parks is not correctly matched?

- (a) Guindy — Tamil Nadu
- (b) Bhagwan Mahavir — Bihar
- (c) Balpakram — Meghalaya
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}-2024

Ans. (b)

Correctly matched National Parks –

- Guindy ----- Tamil Nadu
- Bhagwan Mahavir ----- Goa
- Balpakram ----- Meghalaya

32. Sultanpur Bird Sanctuary is situated in –

- (a) Chandigarh
- (b) Bharatpur
- (c) Gurgaon
- (d) Gandhi Nagar

56th to 59th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2015

Ans. (c)

Sultanpur Bird Sanctuary is located in Gurgaon (Now Gurugram) district of Haryana. These are essentially a bird watcher's Paradise with few trees obscuring the visitor view of the Lake. The bird here can be easily spotted wearing, swimming of flying. Every year almost 90 migratory bird species arrive here in search of feeding ground and to spend the winter.

33. The Salim Ali Bird Sanctuary is located in

- (a) Uttar Pradesh
- (b) Madhya Pradesh
- (c) West Bengal
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (e)

Salim Ali Bird Sanctuary is an estuarine mangrove habitat, which is declared as the bird sanctuary and located on western tip of the Island of Chorao along the Mandovi river, Goa in India.

34. Which of the following is the largest storehouse of alternative energy?

- (a) Solar Energy
- (b) Tidal Energy
- (c) Nuclear Energy
- (d) Geo-Thermal Energy

40th B.P.S.C.. (Pre) 1995

Ans. (a)

Solar energy is radiant light and heat from the sun that is harnessed using a range of ever-evolving technologies such as solar heating, photo-voltaic's, solar thermal energy etc. It is an important source of renewable energy and its technologies are broadly characterized as either passive solar or active solar depending on how they capture and distribute solar energy or convert it into solar power.

35. Solar energy is drawn from which of the following :

- (a) Moon
- (b) Ocean
- (c) Sun
- (d) Wind

44th B.P.S.C.. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (c)

See the explanation of the above question.

36. The major component of CNG is:

- (a) CO₂
- (b) N₂
- (c) H₂
- (d) CH₄
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2020

Ans. (d)

The use of diesel and petrol as fuels in automobiles is being replaced by CNG (Compressed Natural Gas), because CNG produces the harmful products in very small amounts. The major component of CNG is the first member of the alkanes family that is Methane (CH₄).

37. Which is the first Indian airline company that used biofuel as ATF in August 2018?

- (a) Jet Airways
- (b) Vistara
- (c) Air India
- (d) SpiceJet
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

64th B.P.S.C.. (Pre) 2018

Ans. (d)

On August 27, 2018, SpiceJet successfully conducted India's first ever Bio Fuel powered flight. The airline successfully undertook the flight on the Dehradun-Delhi route. SpiceJet used its Bombardier Q400 aircraft for this flight.

38. The International Solar Alliance (ISA) has recently signed a pact with which international organization to promote solar energy deployment in Asia and Pacific?

- (a) Asian Infrastructure Investment Bank
- (b) New Development Bank
- (c) African Development Bank
- (d) Asian Development Bank
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

In March 2018, the International Solar Alliance (ISA) has signed a pact with the Asian Development Bank (ADB) to promote solar energy deployment in Asia and the Pacific.

39. Which district has become the India's first district to have 100% solar-powered health centres?

- (a) Kolkata
- (b) Chennai
- (c) Bengaluru
- (d) Surat
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

Surat district of the Gujarat, becomes the first district in the country to have 100 percent solar powered Primary Health Centres (PHCs). As on 26th March, 2018, all 52 PHCs in the district are powered by a solar system.

40. Which of the following smart cities has become the India's first city to run on 100% renewable energy during daytime?

- (a) Bengaluru
- (b) Jaipur
- (c) Indore
- (d) Diu
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (d)

Diu Smart City has become the first city in India, to runs 100 percent renewable energy during daytime.

41. Pollutant emission gas in vehicle exhaust is mainly –

- (a) Carbon dioxide
- (b) Carbon monoxide
- (c) Marsh gas
- (d) Nitrogen oxide

44th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2000

Ans. (b)

Carbon monoxide is the main pollutant emission gas in vehicle exhaust.

42. Inhalation of air polluted with carbon monoxide (CO) is dangerous because

- (a) CO combines with oxygen in blood
- (b) CO combines with hemoglobin
- (c) CO removes water from the body and causes dehydration
- (d) CO causes coagulation of proteins in the body
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (b)

Carbon monoxide is harmful because it binds to hemoglobin in the blood, reducing the ability of blood to carry oxygen. This interferes with oxygen delivery to the body's organs. The most common effects of CO exposure are fatigue, headaches, confusion, and dizziness due to inadequate oxygen delivery to the brain.

43. The component(s) of acid rain is/are:

- (a) HNO_3
- (b) H_2SO_4
- (d) CO_2
- (e) Both (a) and (b)
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. Re-Exam 2020

Ans. (d)

Acid rain is caused by a chemical reaction that begins when a compound like sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxides are released into the air. These substances can rise very high into the atmosphere where they mix and react with water, oxygen and other chemical to form more acidic pollutants. When these pollutants fall on the surface with rain, it is termed acid rain. Normally, the pH value of acid rain is less than 5.6. Notably, the pH value of pure water is 7.0.

44. Acid rain is caused by –

- (a) Industries
- (b) Petrol
- (c) Burning coal
- (d) Wood

47th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2005

Ans. (a)

While a small portion of sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide that causes acid rain is from natural resources such as volcanoes, most of it comes from the burning of fossil fuels. The major sources of sulphur dioxide and nitrogen oxide in the atmosphere are -

- Burning of fossil fuels,
- Vehicles and heavy equipment,
- Manufacturing, oil refineries and other industries.

45. Earth Day is celebrated on every 22nd April related with–

- (a) End of the Second World War day
- (b) Declaration of no use of nuclear weapons on earth planet
- (c) Public awareness about environment issues
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}–2024

Ans. (c)

Earth Day is celebrated on April 22 every year. It's a global event that aims to raise awareness about environmental issues and encourage people to take action to protect the planet. Earth Day was first observed on April 22, 1970, when an estimated 20 million people nationwide attended the inaugural events at tens of thousands of sites including elementary and secondary schools, universities, and community sites across the United States. When this year 2024 its theme is "Planet vs Plastic".

46. The major and top source of oxygen in the atmosphere is

- (a) Photosynthesis by forest plants
- (b) Photosynthesis by oceanic plants
- (c) Photosynthesis by grassland ecosystem
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}–2024

Ans. (b)

The use of energy from sunlight by plants doing photosynthesis is the basis of life on Earth. Photosynthesis is important due to two reasons: it is the primary source of all food on Earth. It is also responsible for the release of oxygen into the atmosphere by green plants.

Scientists estimate that roughly half of the oxygen production on Earth comes from the ocean. The majority of this production is from oceanic plankton — drifting

plants, algae, and some bacteria that can photosynthesize. One particular species, *Prochlorococcus*, is the smallest photosynthetic organism on Earth. But this little bacteria produces up to 20% of the oxygen in our entire biosphere. That's a higher percentage than all of the tropical rainforests on land combined.

47. The Union Cabinet has approved MoU between India and SACEP for cooperation on oil and chemical pollution in the South Asian seas region. What does SACEP stand for?

- (a) South Asia Compatibility Environment Programme
- (b) South Asia Cooperative Environment Programme
- (c) South Asia Connectivity Environment Programme
- (d) South Asia Coercive Environment Programme
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

63rd B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2017

Ans. (b)

In 2018, the Union Cabinet has approved MoU (Memorandum of Understanding) between India and SACEP for cooperation on Oil and Chemical Pollution in the South Asian Seas Region. Here SACEP stands for 'South Asia Cooperative Environment Programme'.

48. SPMs are used for tracking air quality and for regulating air pollution. Here SPM stands for

- (a) Solidified Particulate Matter
- (b) Suspended Particulate Matter
- (c) Soluble Particulate Matter
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}–2024

Ans. (b)

Suspended particulate matter (SPM) is a type of air pollution that refers to solid and liquid particles suspended in the air. These particles can come from a variety of sources, including: Industrial emissions, Traffic, Construction, Agriculture, and Natural sources like dust and pollen. SPM can be harmful to human health. The smallest particles are the most harmful, and can cause respiratory and cardiovascular diseases.

49. The name of India's third research station in Antarctica?

- (a) Bharati
- (b) Swagatam

(c) Hindustan

(d) Maitri

53rd to 55th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2011

Ans. (a)

Bharati is an Antarctic research station commissioned by India. It is India's third Antarctic research facility and one of the two active research stations alongside Maitri.

50. The five rhino range nations, who signed a declaration "The New Delhi Declaration on Asian Rhinos 2019" are India, Nepal, Malaysia, Indonesia and :

- (a) Vietnam
- (b) Thailand
- (c) Myanmar
- (d) Bhutan
- (e) None of the above/ more than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (d)

India and four rhino range nations (Nepal, Malaysia, Indonesia and Bhutan) have signed a declaration 'The New Delhi Declaration on Asian Rhinos 2019' for the conservation and protection of the species at the recently held Second Asian Rhino Range countries meeting. It is noteworthy that Second Asian Rhino Range countries meeting (from February 26 to 28 in 2019) was held at New Delhi and organized by the Ministry of Environment, Forest and Climate Change of Government of India in collaboration with the IUCN Asian Rhino Specialist Group, WWF - India and Aaranyak.

51. The United Nations Biodiversity Conference (COP 15) ended on 19th December, 2022 in

- (a) New Delhi
- (b) Montreal
- (c) New York
- (d) Shanghai

B.P.S.C. Assistant Mains (GK) Paper II 2023

Ans. (b)

The United Nations Biodiversity Conference (COP15) ended in Montreal, Canada on 19 December 2022. It is the international agreement to protect 30% of land and oceans by 2030 (30 by 30) and the adoption of the Kunming-Montreal Global Biodiversity Framework.

52. How many Indian beaches have been recommended for the Blue Flag Certification recently?

- (a) Six
- (b) Seven
- (c) Eight
- (d) Nine
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2020

Ans. (c)

Eight Indian beaches spread across five states and two union territories, have been awarded the 'Blue Flag Certification' by an eminent international jury, comprising members of UNEP (United Nations Environment Programme), UNWTO (United Nations World Tourism Organization), FEE (Foundation for Environment Education) and IUCN (International Union for Conservation of Nature). The beaches that have been awarded the 'Blue Flag' are Shivrajpur (Dwarka-Gujarat), Ghoghla (Diu), Kararkod and Padubidri (Karnataka), Kappad (Kerala), Rushikonda (Andhra Pradesh), Radhanagar (Andaman & Nicobar Islands) and Golden beach (Puri-Odisha). India now has 12 Blue Flag beaches, an eco-label given to the cleanest beaches in the World.

53. Which one of the following is the world's richest region from a marine biodiversity perspective, comprising 21 islands with estuaries, beaches, forests of the nearshore environment, seagrasses, coral reefs, salt marshes and mangroves?

- (a) Sunderbans Biosphere Reserve
- (b) Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve
- (c) Nanda Devi Biosphere Reserve
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

68th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2022

Ans. (b)

The Gulf of Mannar Biosphere Reserve covers an area 10,500 Square Kilometer on the south-east coast of India across from Sri Lanka. It is one of the world richest regions from a marine biodiversity perspective. The biosphere reserve comprises 21 islands with estuaries, beaches, forests of the nearshore environment, including a marine component with algal communities, sea grasses, coral reefs, salt marshes and mangroves.

54. In which of the following states of India, the maximum teak forest is found?

- (a) Bihar
- (b) Karnataka
- (c) Madhya Pradesh
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}–2024

Ans. (c)

Madhya Pradesh has the maximum teak forest in India. Teak is a tropical hardwood tree species. It is a large, deciduous tree that occurs in mixed hardwood forests. Teak is one of the most important timber trees in India and Southeast Asia. The most important teak forests in India are in Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra, Karnataka, Tamil Nadu, Kerala, Andhra Pradesh.

55. What should be the desired percent of forest area in the total geographical area of the country as outlined in the National Forest Policy of 1952 in India?

- (a) 25
- (b) 33
- (c) 39
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

B.P.S.C. PRT 2023 Shift II

Ans. (b)

The First Forest Policy adopted by British colonial Government in 1894 aimed at a custodial and timber-oriented management. The post independence Forest Policy of 1952 recommended that 33% of the area of the country be brought under forest cover.

56. How many Ramsar Sites are there in India?

- (a) 27
- (b) 39
- (c) 41
- (d) 45
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. Project Manager Prelims 2021

Ans. (*)

As per EIACP Programme Centre "Wildlife & Protected Areas Management" website, on January 2024, India has 80 Ramsar sites in total. A Ramsar site is a wetland site designated to be of international importance under the Ramsar Convention, also known as "The Convention on Wetlands", an international environmental treaty signed on 2 February 1971 in Ramsar, Iran, under the auspices of UNESCO.

57. Which of the following Union Territories has the lowest area under forests?

- (a) Chandigarh
- (b) Puducherry
- (c) Dadra and Nagar Haveli and Daman and Diu
- (d) Lakshadweep
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (a)

As per data released by the Ministry of Environment, Forests And Climate Change, Chandigarh's forest cover has increased by 3.85% between 2019 and 2021. In Chandigarh, spread over 114 sq km, the forest cover was 22.03 sq km as per the ISFR 2019. It increased to 22.88 sq.km. in the ISFR 2021. During the two year period, it increased by 0.85 sq km. According to ISFR 2021, the forest cover area was 27.10 sq. km. in Lakshadweep.

58. According to the World Air Quality Report, 2020, which of the following capitals has been found as the most polluted capital?

- (a) Beijing
- (b) Moscow
- (c) Kathmandu
- (d) New Delhi
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (d)

Delhi was ranked as the world's most polluted capital city in the World Air Quality Report 2020, prepared by Swiss organisation IQ Air. Delhi ranked fourth on a list of 50 of the world's most polluted cities in terms of PM2.5 levels in 2022, according to the World Air Quality Report prepared by IQ Air.

59. Clones of animals are being produced through the practice of

- (a) genetics
- (b) ecology
- (c) biotechnology
- (d) embryology
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

B.P.S.C. CDPO 2022

Ans. (c)

Biotechnology is a portion of biology that deals with biological methods like the genetic manipulation of animals. Cloning is a process achieved through biotechnology. Cloning allows livestock breeders to create an exact genetic copy of an existing animal, essentially an identical twin. Clones are superior breeding animals used to produce healthier offspring.

60. The 'Lisbon Declaration', which made headlines, is associated with the conservation of which entity?

- (a) Air
- (b) Mountains
- (c) Oceans
- (d) Freshwater glaciers

69th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (c)

The Lisbon Declaration is associated with the conservation of oceans. The Lisbon Declaration 'Our Oceans, Our Future, Our Responsibility' called on government to do more to prevent, reduce and eliminate marine plastic including single use plastics and micro plastics.

61. Extensive planting of a single commercially valuable species is called–

- (a) Enrichment plantation
- (b) Mixed farming
- (c) Intensive subsistence farming
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (a)

Enrichment plantation is the practice of clearing out forests to grow a single commercially valuable species. This practice is responsible for eliminating many species in India. An example of enrichment plantation are the teak monocultures in South India.

62. The Asian Cheetah was declared extinct in India in the year–

- (a) 1965
- (b) 1960
- (c) 1950
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (e)

India was once home to the Asiatic cheetah but it was declared extinct there in 1952. The critically endangered subspecies, which once roamed across the Middle East, Central Asia and India, are now only found, in very small numbers, in Iran. The Prime Minister Narendra Modi on September 17, 2022 released wild Cheetahs - which had become extinct from India - in Kuno National Park. Cheetahs - brought from Namibia - are being introduced in India under Project Cheetah, which is world's first inter-continental large wild carnivore translocation project.

63. In which year was the African Convention for the Conservation of Natural Resources held?

- (a) 1990
- (b) 1980
- (c) 1968
- (d) 1960
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (c)

The African Convention on the Conservation of Nature and Natural Resources was adopted in 1968 in Algiers. The convention came into force on June 16, 1969. The convention was adopted by the Assembly of the African Union on July 11, 2003 in Maputo.

64. Where has the Gharial Breeding Center been established in India?

- (a) Corbett (Uttarakhand)
- (b) Sundarbans (W.B.)
- (c) Morena (M.P.)
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (c)

- The Gharial Breeding Center has been established at Deori, near Morena, in Madhya Pradesh. The Center is on the Mumbai-Agra Highway (NH-44).
- The Gharial Breeding Center in India is a facility established to protect and propagate the endangered gharial, a species of crocodilian native to the Indian subcontinent. The center plays a crucial role in conservation efforts by breeding gharials in captivity and releasing them into their natural habitats. The location of such centers is vital for the success of these efforts, as it must align with the ecological needs of the species.

65. Which of these statements is not a valid reason for the depletion of flora and fauna?

- (a) Agricultural expansion
- (b) Large scale development projects
- (c) Grazing and fuel wood collection
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 11-12}–2024

Ans. (c)

Grazing and fuel wood collection is not a valid reason for the depletion of flora and fauna. In fact, proper grazing does not harm flora and fauna, but overgrazing can.

66. The grassland with scattered trees is called as

- (a) Savanna
- (b) Agroforest
- (c) Rain forest
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 1-5}–2024

Ans. (a)

Grassland with scattered trees is called a savanna. Savannas are a type of tropical grassland, characterized by grasses that cover the ground and scattered trees, shrubs, or palms above. Savannas are found in Africa, Australia, South America, and India. Savannas are located between tropical rainforests and deserts. They have two distinct seasons, one rainy and one dry. Climate is the most important factor in creating a savanna.

67. Which state passed the first resolution for joint forest management?

- (a) Tamil Nadu
- (b) Odisha
- (c) Bihar
- (d) More than one of the above
- (e) None of the above

BPSC (Tre-3) {Class 6-8}–2024

Ans. (b)

In realizing the need for community participation in forest protection, the Govt. of Odisha was the pioneer to adopt a policy of Joint Forest Management even before implementation of National Forest Policy, 1988 (w.e.f. 7.12.1988) in the country.

It has initiated a step to involve the people in protection of Reserved forests adjoining their villages with assigning specific roles and in return granting certain concessions (under section 24 of the Odisha Forest Act 1972) for meeting their bonafide requirement of firewood and small timbers.

It has sought community participation for protection, regeneration and management of the forest wealth widening the scope of employment generation and social empowerment of the forest-fringe dwellers.

68. Where is Salim Ali Bird Sanctuary located?

- (a) Goa
- (b) Srinagar
- (c) Odisha
- (d) Maharashtra
- (e) None of the above/More than one of the above

66th B.P.S.C. (Re-Exam) (Pre) 2020

Ans. (a)

Salim Ali Bird Sanctuary is located in Goa. This sanctuary is named after Dr. Salim Moizudin Ali, the eminent Indian Ornithologist.